

Resend

https://resend.com · Email API + marketing email platform · for developers at startups and scale-ups



Resend is one of the few dev-tool sites where the AI scanners trip and a human still wins. The CSS bundle has every 2024 starter-kit move (Inter, gradient text, backdrop blur), but the page itself has a point of view: a serif display face, a monochrome cube, and a working code sample above the fold. The weak spot is the pitch. "Email for developers" names the buyer and stops there. The only outcome on offer is "reach humans instead of spam folders", every email API says that, and there's no number behind it.

FIX THESE FIRST

1. Back up the deliverability promise with a number (inbox placement, time-to-inbox, or a named customer result) in the hero or right under it.
2. Say why Resend beats SendGrid/Postmark in one line above the fold. Today the differentiator (DX, React Email) only shows up three sections down.
3. Remove the hidden "Recommended" badge text from all four pricing tiers. Screen readers and text crawlers read every plan as recommended.
4. Give the Forward event page a real H1/H2 structure. It has no semantic headings at all.

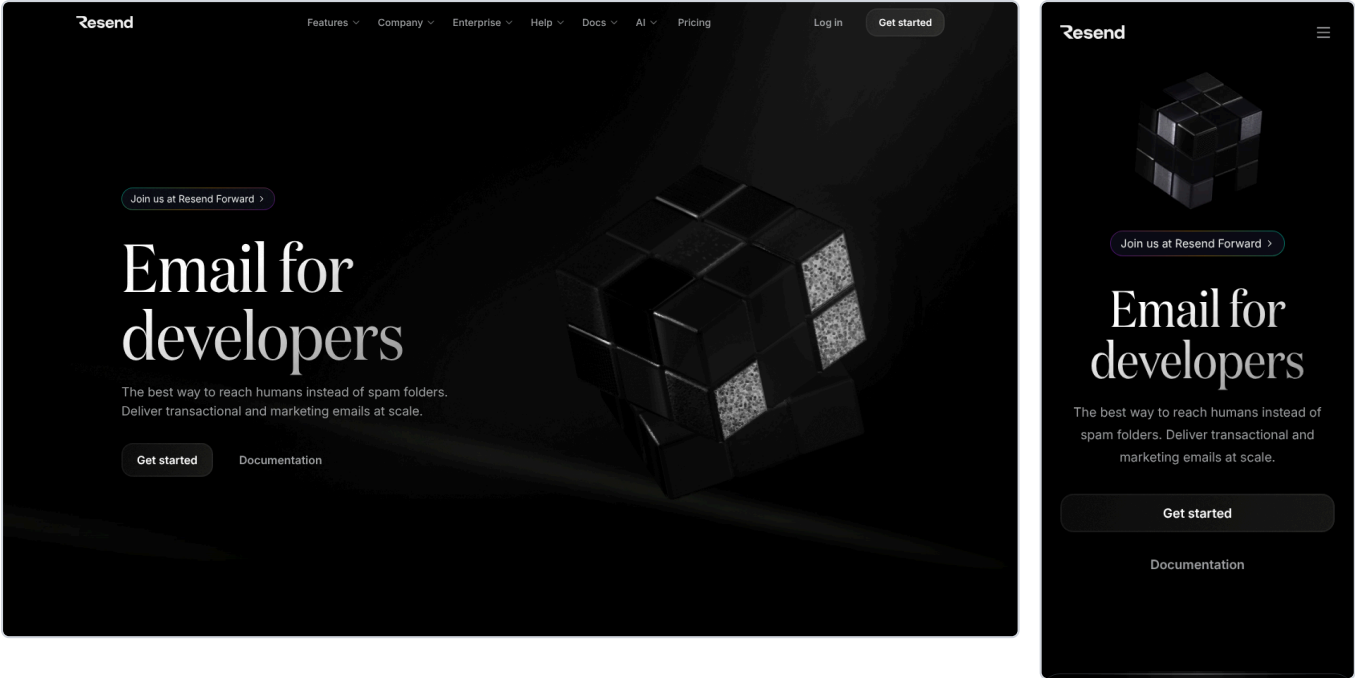
WHAT'S WORKING

- A working code sample sits right under the hero: the product is shown, not described.
- The typography has real art direction (serif display + grotesk). It doesn't look like a template.
- Pricing has a volume slider and per-1,000 overage rates in plain sight, so there's no 'contact sales' wall below enterprise.
- Copy is clean: the deterministic writing scan scored the homepage 3 (minimal) with only one chatbot phrase.

Homepage

Looks expensive and sounds human, but the hero sells a category instead of a reason to switch.

AI copy tells		8/10
AI design tells		7/10
Visual quality & taste		9/10
Readability & clarity		7/10
Pitch & positioning		6/10
Conversion & trust		8/10
Technical hygiene		8/10



AI copy tells

NIT One chatbot phrase and two stock verbs
"feel free to reach out" (flagged critical as a chatbot phrase), "Showcase your logo and company branding with BIMI".
Fix: "Email us at ..." / "Show your logo in inboxes with BIMI".
ai-writing-detector, humanizer · certain

AI design tells

NIT Starter-kit tells in the stylesheet, mostly not on screen
Scanner flags Inter (body + buttons), gradient text, backdrop-blur, and an indigo gradient in the shipped CSS. On the rendered fold only Inter and a faint gradient pill border on the event badge are visible. The serif H1 and the monochrome palette override the default look.
Fix: Optional. Swapping Inter for the brand grotesk (ABC Favorit, already used for H2s) on body copy would remove the last generic layer.
avoid-ai-design (detect.mjs), hallmark · likely

Visual quality & taste

NIT Secondary CTA nearly disappears

"Documentation" is grey text with no border next to the filled "Get started". It reads as disabled on mobile.

Fix: Give it a ghost border or a higher-contrast text colour.

impeccable (audit) · certain

Readability & clarity

FIX Long-scroll feature list with dense prose

Flesch 46, 19 sentences over 30 words, 2,100+ words on the homepage. Twelve H2 sections, each with a paragraph.

Fix: Cut each feature section to a headline + one line + visual; link to the feature page for the rest.

copy-editing, scan.readability · certain

Pitch & positioning

ROAST Hero names the audience, not the advantage

H1 "Email for developers" + "The best way to reach humans instead of spam folders." Deliverability is table stakes for every competitor, and "the best way" is an unbacked superlative.

Fix: Keep the H1 and swap the subhead for a concrete outcome or proof, e.g. a placement rate, time-to-first-send, or a recognisable customer.

copywriting, product-marketing · certain

FIX The real differentiator is buried

"Develop emails using React" (the thing competitors can't claim) is the 9th H2 on the page, after Test mode, Webhooks, Editor, Contacts, and Analytics.

Fix: Promote React Email + DX into the hero or the first section.

product-marketing, marketing-psychology · certain

Technical hygiene

FIX Slow first load

12.5 s to network-idle on the first visit (3.2-3.5 s on later pages), mostly from the 3D hero asset.

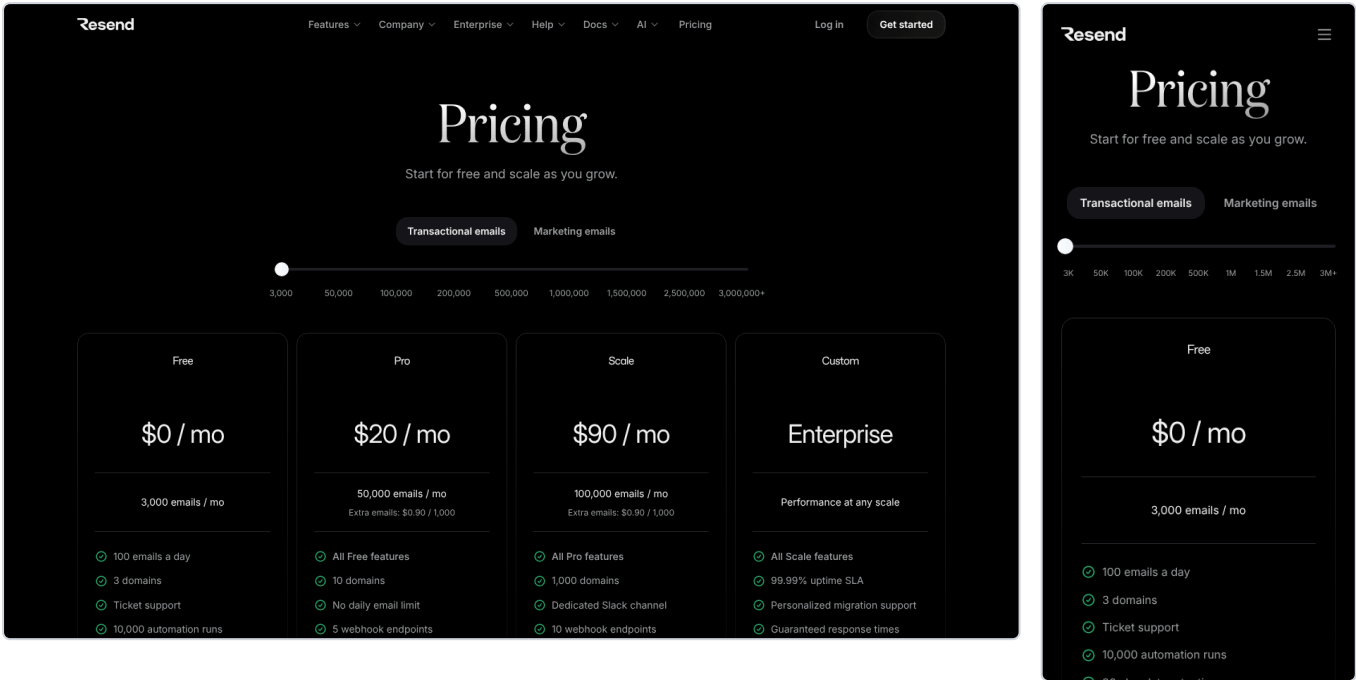
Fix: Lazy-load the cube after first paint and serve a static poster image first.

seo-audit, meta.json · likely

Pricing

Pricing done properly: transparent, interactive, honest about overages. Two markup bugs let it down.

AI copy tells		9/10
AI design tells		7/10
Visual quality & taste		8/10
Readability & clarity		7/10
Pitch & positioning		7/10
Conversion & trust		8/10
Technical hygiene		6/10



Conversion & trust

FIX Four identical "Get started" buttons
Free, Pro, and Scale all say "Get started". There's no visual push toward the plan Resend actually wants you on.
Fix: Highlight one tier and label CTAs by outcome ("Start free", "Go Pro").
cro, marketing-psychology · certain

NIT Odd feature-list entry
"Single Sign-On" is listed under Free and Pro, but the page also sells SSO as a \$150/mo add-on.
Fix: Show it as a struck-through or 'add-on' row so the list doesn't contradict the add-ons section.
cro · likely

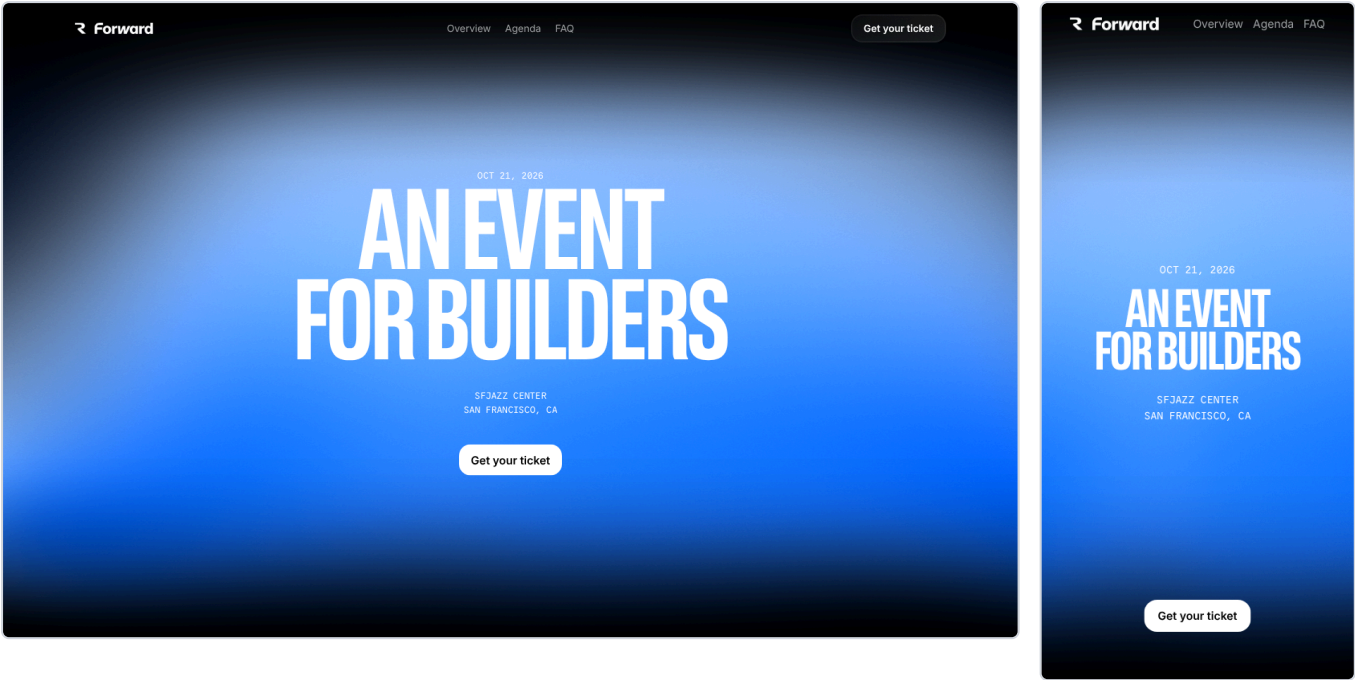
Technical hygiene

FIX Every tier is secretly "Recommended"
Headings read "Free Recommended", "Pro Recommended", "Scale Recommended", "Custom Recommended". The badge is hidden visually but present in the text, so screen readers and AI crawlers see four recommended plans.
Fix: Render the badge only on the recommended tier, or aria-hide the inactive ones.
web-design-guidelines, ai-seo · likely

Resend Forward (event)

Loud, confident event page. It's the one place on the site that drifts toward the AI-template look.

AI copy tells		9/10
AI design tells		5/10
Visual quality & taste		7/10
Readability & clarity		7/10
Conversion & trust		8/10
Technical hygiene		4/10



AI design tells

FIX Blue radial-glow hero + tracked mono caps

Full-bleed blurred blue gradient, condensed all-caps headline, and letter-spaced monospace meta lines ("OCT 21, 2026", "SFJAZZ CENTER"). This is the 'tasteful AI' event-page cluster from the avoid-ai-design catalogue (SD4).

Fix: Bring in the main site's art direction (serif, monochrome, cube) so the event feels like Resend, not a generic conference template.

avoid-ai-design, frontend-design · certain

Readability & clarity

NIT Everything is shouting

Speaker names, roles, and stage labels are all uppercase ("VP OF MARKETING AND COMMUNITY, LARAVEL"), which slows scanning in a 20+ name list.

Fix: Use sentence case for roles, and keep caps for names or stage labels only.

impeccable (typeset) · certain

Technical hygiene

ROAST No semantic headings at all

Zero visible H1/H2/H3 elements. "AN EVENT FOR BUILDERS" is styled text, and the meta description is just the title.

Fix: Make the headline an H1 and section labels (Speakers, Agenda, FAQ) H2s. Write a real meta description.

seo-audit, web-design-guidelines · certain

Method

Each page was rendered in Chromium at 1440px and 390px. Deterministic detectors ran on the copy and the shipped CSS. Reviewers then judged the screenshots and copy through each lens, using the open-source skills listed below. Severity: **Roast** = actively costs trust or conversions; **Fix** = clear improvement; **Nit** = polish.

About "AI tells": a tell means the page uses a default that generative tools overproduce. It is not proof the site was AI-made, and no finding here is an authorship claim.

SKILLS USED

ai-writing-detector	conorbronsdon/avoid-ai-writing@2elec15c96	MIT
avoid-ai-writing	conorbronsdon/avoid-ai-writing@2elec15c96	MIT
humanizer	blader/humanizer@225a6f39ac	MIT
avoid-ai-design	funboy322/avoid-ai-design@2b7c71836b	MIT
hallmark	nutlope/hallmark@13ac0ec7e1	MIT
impeccable	pbakaus/impeccable@9ffc1eafe5	Apache-2.0
web-design-guidelines	vercel-labs/agent-skills@063bee94c3	MIT
frontend-design	anthropics/skills@683bc88e56	Apache-2.0
product-marketing	coreyhaines31/marketingskills@5e721d73ac	MIT
cro	coreyhaines31/marketingskills@5e721d73ac	MIT
copywriting	coreyhaines31/marketingskills@5e721d73ac	MIT
copy-editing	coreyhaines31/marketingskills@5e721d73ac	MIT
marketing-psychology	coreyhaines31/marketingskills@5e721d73ac	MIT
seo-audit	coreyhaines31/marketingskills@5e721d73ac	MIT
ai-seo	coreyhaines31/marketingskills@5e721d73ac	MIT